

DANCE

OVERVIEW

Dance at the Grade 9 and 10 level introduces students to the notions that movement is a medium of expression and that the human body is an instrument. Dance transforms images, ideas, and feelings into movement sequences. Learning in dance requires a balance of knowledge, skills, and attitudes, and embraces movement, creation, and performance. Appreciation of dance expands students' awareness of the richness of various cultures around the world. The study and practice of composition provide students with the essential building blocks that support lifelong interest in, appreciation of, and curiosity about dance.

Students develop their kinesthetic awareness and use the elements of dance (body, space, time, energy, and relationship) to compose dance creations. Students also develop dance technique, which emphasizes physiological and safety factors while allowing them to enhance their ability to use the body and all its parts for creative expression.

The art of dance should be shared. Through informal presentations and more formal performances, students use dance to communicate their aesthetic and personal values. By experiencing, analysing, and commenting on the performances of others, students enhance their understanding of the values of other dance artists and cultures.

Students learn about the dynamic relationship between process and product through creating their own choreography and interpreting existing dance works. They also develop their understanding of the role of dance in various cultures, societies, and historical periods.

The expectations for courses in dance are organized into three distinct but related strands:

1. ***Creating and Presenting:*** Students use the creative process (see pages 14–16) to create, re-create, and present dance composition in a variety of contexts. The effective use of this process requires a nurturing environment that encourages students to explore their ideas freely and without inhibition. Creative work in dance involves the realization of exercises, explorations, experiments, dance works, and productions through the development of students' abilities, skills, and competencies.
2. ***Reflecting, Responding, and Analysing:*** The critical analysis process (see pages 16–20) at this level promotes rational and logical thinking for learning in, about, and through dance. Students respond to, analyse, reflect on, and evaluate dance performances; explore and research the forms and functions of dance; and begin to understand dance as a universal language.

3. **Foundations:** This strand encompasses the body of knowledge, concepts, conventions, and norms that create an underpinning and a context for dance as an arts discipline. Learning how to move the human body and expanding its movement vocabulary help students understand how and why people dance. This strand emphasizes the importance of health and safety, historical and cultural context, dance vocabulary, and a variety of protocols related to ethics and etiquette.

For policy guidelines pertaining to focus courses, see pages 11–12 of this document.

The list of approved focus courses for Dance can be found at:

www.edu.gov.on.ca/eng/curriculum/secondary/arts.html.

Dance, Grade 10

Open

ATC20

This course emphasizes the development of students' technique and creative skills relating to the elements of dance and the tools of composition in a variety of performance situations. Students will identify responsible personal and interpersonal practices related to dance processes and production, and will apply technologies and techniques throughout the process of creation to develop artistic scope in the dance arts.

Prerequisite: None

A. CREATING, PRESENTING, AND PERFORMING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- A1. The Creative Process:** use the creative process, the elements of dance, and a variety of sources to develop movement vocabulary;
- A2. Choreography and Composition:** combine the elements of dance in a variety of ways in composing individual and ensemble dance creations;
- A3. Dance Techniques:** demonstrate an understanding of the dance techniques and movement vocabularies of a variety of dance forms from around the world;
- A4. Performance:** apply dance presentation skills in a variety of contexts and performances.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

A1. The Creative Process

By the end of this course, students will:

- A1.1** use the elements of dance to create and perform a variety of movement phrases inspired by sources (e.g., select key words, images, and messages from the poem “My Name Is Gossip” and interpret them through a variety of movement phrases; create a short dance composition based on a personal, social, or environmental issue)

Teacher prompts: “What sources can you examine to enhance your exploration of this social or environmental issue?” “Can movement communicate some messages better than words? What types of messages?”

- A1.2** create and perform phrases that manipulate three or more elements of dance (e.g., with a partner, create movement phrases in three-quarter time, juxtaposing symmetrical and asymmetrical shapes; repeat their phrases, adding an element of energy [fast, slow, light, or strained] and focusing on the relationship between the two movers)

Teacher prompt: “How might you perform your phrase again with a percussive quality and then with a fluid quality? Which version did you like best and why?”

- A1.3** use the elements of dance to create and perform movement vocabulary through guided improvisation (e.g., use flocking to explore slow-motion movement, changes of levels, and changes of direction/facings)

Teacher prompts: “What are the challenges of leading others while remaining spontaneous?” “What requirements can be included in the guided improvisational structure in order to encourage creative exploration?”

- A1.4** develop multiple solutions to movement problems following specific guidelines for performance (e.g., vary a sixteen-bar movement phrase by exploring it first as a stationary phrase and then as a locomotor phrase; introduce two pathway changes to help emphasize or reconfigure particular movements within their phrases)

Teacher prompt: “What movement problem do you need to solve? What strategy can you use to develop a solution?”

A2. Choreography and Composition

By the end of this course, students will:

- A2.1** use a variety of choreographic forms, structures, and techniques to connect a series of movement phrases (e.g., rearrange a phrase learned in class and perform it in a tight clump in unison; retrograde a second phrase and perform it as a canon, then return to the first phrase and repeat to reveal an ABA structure)

Teacher prompt: “What choreographic techniques could you use to make a smooth transition between one structure or phrase and another? Would the same techniques work with different types of phrases?”

A2.2 construct a dance composition inspired by a source (e.g., *create a dance composition inspired by a two- or three-dimensional art work, or a musical excerpt or poem*)

Teacher prompts: “What are the challenges of selecting a source from one medium and using it to inspire a dance composition?” “What process could you use to help stimulate the creation of phrases for your composition?”

A2.3 use a variety of compositional approaches to extend their ability to express ideas through dance (e.g., *use approaches such as guided improvisation, responding to the stimulus of a poem or a social or environmental issue, or varying and repeating phrases in ABA form*)

Teacher prompt: “Which compositional approaches do you think you will find most helpful in developing your artistic voice and why?”

A3. Dance Techniques

By the end of this course, students will:

A3.1 apply a kinesthetic awareness of the vocabularies within a variety of dance forms from around the world (e.g., *explore and practise basic movements from ballet, modern dance, Afro-Brazilian dance such as samba, and modern/jazz dance [as conceived by dance creators such as Gus Giordiano, Reginald Ray Savage, Wade Robson, Eva Von Gencsy, Vicki Adam-Willis]*)

Teacher prompt: “What are the similarities between the dance vocabulary in ballet and modern dance? What is their relationship to gravity? Can you demonstrate their differences in terms of how the spine is used?”

A3.2 accurately reproduce a given spatial pattern or pathway (e.g., *perform a tendu exercise en croix with a partner and provide feedback to help the partner make corrections; repeat the exercise noting improvements*)

Teacher prompt: “How could providing feedback to others help your own development of movement skills?”

A3.3 arrange and present extended sequences using the dance vocabulary and techniques of an identified dance form (e.g., *rearrange and extend a ballet centre combination by adding familiar stationary and travelling ballet steps*)

Teacher prompt: “What will you do to maintain a sense of flow in your phrases when rearranging the movements?”

A4. Performance

By the end of this course, students will:

A4.1 revise and refine movement to enhance dance performance and interpretation (e.g., *revisit already created phrases to clarify the movement, energy, pathways, formations, and counts and timing*)

Teacher prompt: “How is revising and refining a dance similar to reworking and editing an essay in English? What are the steps you will need to follow?”

A4.2 use the tools of stagecraft in dance performances, including performances at alternative venues (e.g., *suggest solutions for staging problems presented by an alternative or unconventional performance environment, such as an outdoor site*)

Teacher prompt: “What challenges do you face in staging a dance piece in a non-standard performance environment? What are some performance/production considerations related to music/sound, audience sight lines, and the presence of external distractions such as traffic noise?”

A4.3 apply an understanding of the importance of stage presence in rehearsal and performance (e.g., *maintain focus and alertness throughout their performance*)

Teacher prompt: “What type of behaviour will show the teacher or the audience that you are fully engaged in your rehearsal or performance?”

B. REFLECTING, RESPONDING, AND ANALYSING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1. The Critical Analysis Process:** use the critical analysis process to reflect on and evaluate their own and others' dance works and activities;
- B2. Dance and Society:** demonstrate an understanding of how societies present and past use or have used dance, and of how creating and viewing dance can benefit individuals, groups, and communities;
- B3. Connections Beyond the Classroom:** demonstrate an understanding of the purpose and possibilities of continuing engagement in dance arts.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

B1. The Critical Analysis Process

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1.1** use the critical analysis process to identify and compare a wide variety of dance forms (e.g., *compare features of the dance forms experienced in the Grade 10 dance program*)

Teacher prompt: "What are some common features that most dance forms share?"

- B1.2** analyse dance works in terms of both their content and their fluency, artistry, or expressiveness (e.g., *describe the individual movement combinations in a dance piece and determine whether they have been put together effectively to create a successful work*)

Teacher prompts: "At what point does a combination of steps become choreography?" "How do technique and artistry come together to create a successful performance from a group such as Motus O Dance Theatre? Have you ever seen a performance that demonstrated one and not the other? What was your reaction?"

B2. Dance and Society

By the end of this course, students will:

- B2.1** describe the characteristics and function of a world dance form (e.g., *an oppression dance such as gumboot*)

Teacher prompt: "What are the characteristics of world dances of celebration, oppression,

and mourning? What are their purpose? How would you describe the difference among these dances?"

- B2.2** explain how dance exploration can contribute to personal growth and self-understanding (e.g., *how they have benefited from listening to feedback or trying to respond to constructive criticism*)

Teacher prompt: "What are some ways in which feedback from teachers or peers has helped you improve your work in dance?"

- B2.3** identify and describe ways in which different types of dance reflect the cultures that produced them (e.g., *Kathak expresses devotion to Hindu gods; the hoop dance reflects Aboriginal beliefs about how all living things on the earth grow, change, and are connected*)

Teacher prompts: "What do you know about the dances of your ancestors? How do they reflect the history of your culture?" "What beliefs about the natural world are expressed in the Aboriginal hoop dance or animal dance?"

- B2.4** demonstrate an understanding of how dance exploration and presentations can contribute to the school and the broader community (e.g., *use visual, oral, or written means to describe school, community, and professional dance productions they have attended or presented, and explain how they and others benefited from the experience*)

Teacher prompt: "When the local dance studios do their big annual productions, how might we benefit by attending those productions?"

B3. Connections Beyond the Classroom

By the end of this course, students will:

- B3.1** identify physical, intellectual, and artistic skills that are developed through dance and explain how they can be applied to a variety of careers (*e.g., with a partner, research and report on possible summer volunteer or employment opportunities where their learning in dance could be helpful*)

Teacher prompt: “What skills that you’ve learned in dance class are required for employment in any field?”

- B3.2** identify and describe ways in which dance arts could play a greater role in their community (*e.g., identify groups in the community who might benefit from dance activities but who are not currently served by dance organizations*)

Teacher prompt: “How could dance organizations do outreach to bring the benefits of dance to all members of the community, including the elderly and people who are physically challenged or developmentally delayed?”

- B3.3** develop and maintain a traditional or digital portfolio to document and analyse their dance-related learning in a variety of ways (*e.g., through photographs, ticket stubs, programs, videos, recorded or written personal reflections*), and use it to analyse their strengths and areas that need improvement

Teacher prompt: “Based on the materials in your portfolio, how would you describe your development as a dancer? What knowledge and skills have you acquired or strengthened along the way? What have been your most memorable moments? Why?”

C. FOUNDATIONS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1. Physiology and Terminology:** demonstrate an understanding of, and use correct terminology when referring to, the physiology of movement as it relates to dance;
- C2. Contexts and Influences:** demonstrate an understanding of the social, cultural, and historical origins and development of dance forms, including their influence on each other and on society;
- C3. Responsible Practices:** demonstrate an understanding of safe, ethical, and responsible personal and interpersonal practices in dance activities.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

C1. Physiology and Terminology

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1.1** demonstrate an understanding of the importance of a positive body image and a healthy lifestyle to their learning in dance (*e.g., explain how self-esteem and positive nutritional choices can enhance their learning and development in dance; create a collage of magazine images that represent stereotypes of beauty*)

Teacher prompt: “Do fashion magazines agree on a standard version of beauty? If so, what are its main characteristics? In what ways is this version the same as or different from your own ideas about beauty? The ideas of your peers?”

- C1.2** demonstrate an understanding of basic muscular anatomy as it relates to movement (*e.g., outline the characteristics and functions of cardiac muscle, smooth muscle, and skeletal muscle*)

Teacher prompt: “Which muscles appear to be the prime movers of the bones that lie underneath the muscle?”

- C1.3** demonstrate, and describe using correct terminology, the movement repertoire of a variety of dance forms from around the world (*e.g., movements associated with breakdance, such as uprock, freeze, rollback, six-step, zulu spins*)

Teacher prompt: “Why is it important to be able to describe movements as well as demonstrate them?”

C2. Contexts and Influences

By the end of this course, students will:

- C2.1** identify and describe the contributions of some dance pioneers to particular dance forms (*e.g., Martha Graham’s influence on modern dance; Loie Fuller’s contribution to modern dance and dance on film; Luigi’s contribution to jazz dance*)

Teacher prompts: “What are some common character traits of these pioneers?” “How did Isadora Duncan’s connection to sacred art influence how she created dance? How did her lifestyle and the way she was perceived by society affect modern dance at the time?”

- C2.2** identify and describe ways in which dance addresses social questions of local and/or global interest (*e.g., explain how the choreography of a dance work on a social justice or environmental theme helps communicate the intended message*)

Teacher prompts: “After viewing *Sarah* by Kaeja d’Dance, can you identify the social justice issues that were the basis for its creation? What particular structures or techniques were most effective in communicating its message? What other choreographies have you seen that portray a theme of social justice? What techniques and structures do they use?” “What dance programs have the CityDance Ensemble of Washington created, and what environmental messages have they presented?”

C2.3 identify and describe similarities and differences in some dance genres from around the world, and illustrate them through performance (e.g., compare the use of ritual as a key element in two or more dance genres; use a concept attainment chart to compare the key features of various dance genres)

Teacher prompt: “In performance and/or in writing, compare and contrast breakdance and capoeira, or Chinese fan dance and classical ballet. What do you need to consider before getting started?”

C3. Responsible Practices

By the end of this course, students will:

C3.1 identify and follow responsible practices in dance activities (e.g., explain the need for and demonstrate discipline in daily dance practice; identify and carry out the responsibilities of assigned roles; respect the boundaries between their own and others’ roles)

Teacher prompt: “What roles are involved in carrying out this task? Do any of the roles overlap? Are any responsibilities not covered? How can you clarify the roles to avoid both gaps and duplication?”

C3.2 demonstrate problem-solving skills during rehearsal and performance (e.g., find ways to work constructively with others; explore a variety of possibilities to find solutions to artistic problems)

Teacher prompt: “Why is it important to explore all options and listen to all feedback when creating phrases and compositions?”

C3.3 identify and follow safe and ethical practices in dance activities in both classroom and performance settings (e.g., maintain appropriate distances; use equipment safely; refrain from displays of temperament and respond constructively to “acting out” by others; develop a class definition of choreographic property; identify and acknowledge copyrighted material)

Teacher prompts: “What are some key safety issues we face in dance class?” “What character traits do you want to see celebrated in our dance studio, and why?” “What are some differences between choreographic property, intellectual property, written property, and creative property? Which is easiest to define?”